

The Animal Kingdom as proof against it. This text classified animals according to anatomy, dividing them into four groups: vertebrates, mollusks, articulates (such as arthropods), and radiates (those with radial symmetry, like starfish).

Cuvier insisted that animals did not change over time, refuting the possibility of evolution. While this view was later disproved, Cuvier's system radically advanced the understanding of animal anatomy. His work forms the foundations of paleontology and comparative anatomy.



LOUIS AGASSIZ

A Swiss-born naturalist and geologist, Louis Agassiz made significant scientific advances through his work on glaciers and fossilized fish.



The extensive work of Louis Agassiz (1807–1873) into fossilized fish during the 1830s proved highly influential in the study of extinct life forms. His later geological studies of glaciers led him to conclude that much of the world had been covered in a vast ice sheet until relatively recently. A supporter of Cuvier's catastrophism theory, he cited ice ages as types of catastrophe that had affected the Earth. While these ice-age theories are supported by modern geology, Agassiz, like Cuvier, rejected the idea of evolution.

